



POLESTAR APAC WEEKLY - 2026-09-20

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

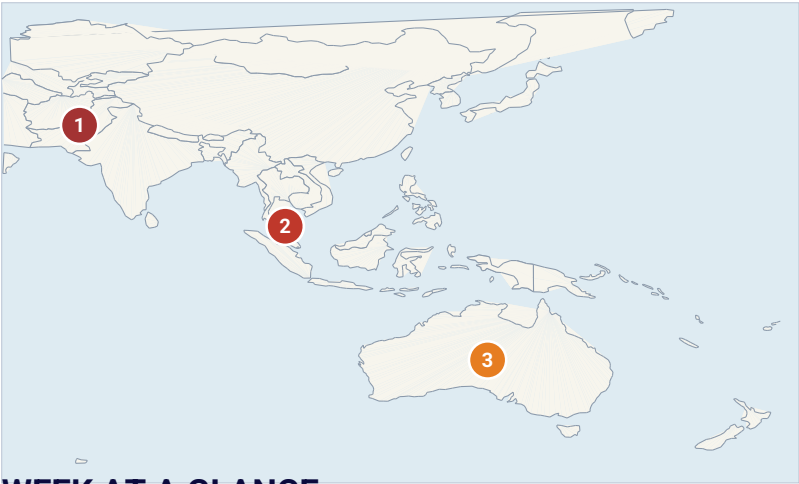
REPORTING PERIOD: 14 SEPTEMBER 2026 - 20 SEPTEMBER 2026

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REGIONAL OUTLOOK

The principal APAC changes this week were Pakistan security forces attack in Pakistan and Australia migration policy tightening in Australia. A car bomb struck a police facility in Kohat, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa; and Attackers detonated a bomb and opened fire on a vehicle carrying territorial defence volunteers in Narathiwat on 18 September. The High or Extreme assessments are confined to Pakistan (Pakistan security forces attack) and Thailand (Bomb, shooting attack on defence volunteer truck in Narathiwat); they do not establish the same operating condition across the region. No material weather, cyber or infrastructure event entered the final evidence set after those domains were checked. The lower-severity but potentially broader business change is Australia tightened migration and visa settings, changing eligibility and documentation requirements for affected workers and visitors. This distinction matters: violent events require location-specific movement and security decisions, while energy, transport or workforce measures can spread through cargo schedules, staffing and compliance even when their immediate physical severity is lower. The business response should therefore be selective. Security and travel teams should tighten controls only around the named attack or military locations and avoid converting strategic concern into unsupported closure claims. Operations teams should verify the status of any affected airport, terminal, pipeline or route before rerouting. Workforce and compliance teams should identify the employee groups actually caught by the reported policy change. A broader regional escalation would require evidence that one of these local effects is spreading into a major transport corridor, operating site or critical supply chain; absent that transmission, the report supports local controls rather than a general change in regional posture.

REGIONAL HOTSPOT MAP



1 PAKISTAN
PAKISTAN SECURITY FORCES ATTACK

18 Sep · A car bomb struck a police facility in Kohat, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa.

2 THAILAND
BOMB, SHOOTING ATTACK ON DEFENCE

18 Sep · Attackers detonated a bomb and opened fire on a vehicle carrying territorial defence volunteers in

3 AUSTRALIA
MIGRATION RULE CHANGE

17 Sep · Australia tightened migration and visa settings, changing eligibility and documentation requirements for

WEEK AT A GLANCE

MATERIAL DEVELOPMENTS
3
HIGH OR EXTREME DEVELOPMENTS
2

MARKETS REQUIRING WATCH
3
7-DAY WATCH ITEMS
1

REGIONAL RISK PICTURE

The week's risk picture has two different scales. Physical-security events are acute but geographically narrow. Pakistan: The immediate exposure is to personnel safety and security-site access; the assessment depends on whether the incident remains contained, prompts new restrictions or produces repeat disruption around the named location; and Thailand: The immediate exposure is to personnel safety and security-site access; the assessment depends on whether the incident remains contained, prompts new restrictions or produces repeat disruption around the named location Their regional importance comes from what could follow, not from an assumption that the first incident already disrupted every nearby business. A repeat attack, a wider security cordon or restrictions on a transport node would convert a local threat into an operating constraint; without that evidence, exposure remains concentrated around the named locations. Continuity developments have a different transmission path. No selected energy, transport, weather or cyber event created a material continuity change. These events matter when a damaged asset or suspended service removes an alternative used by cargo, travellers or suppliers. Duration is therefore more important than headline intensity. A short suspension with available rerouting is manageable; prolonged loss of capacity, congestion at the substitute route or an unresolved repair schedule would spread the effect. Policy exposure is broader but normally slower. Australia: The measure changes workforce eligibility, documentation or travel planning; the practical effect depends on the effective rule and affected worker categories The affected population, implementation timetable and treatment of existing permissions determine the real business burden. Companies should avoid applying a nationality-, visa- or market-specific rule to unaffected staff or operations. Across the selected evidence, there is no basis for one regional risk level. Security controls should follow the attack geography; logistics controls should follow verified service status and available alternatives; workforce controls should follow the exact scope of the rule. The cross-domain risk is highest where these pressures overlap-for example, a security event that closes the only practical route, or a workforce restriction that reduces recovery capacity during a disruption. That overlap is not yet established across the region, but it is the threshold that would change the assessment.

DEVELOPMENTS BY TYPE

Armed Conflict		2
Regulatory		1

KEY DEVELOPMENTS

Pakistan | Pakistan
18 Sep 2026
Pakistan security forces attack

Category: Armed Conflict
Current Severity: Extreme
Assessment: A car bomb struck a police facility in Kohat, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa.
Polestar View: The event is most consequential if follow-on security measures restrict access around Pakistan, disrupt nearby operations or indicate a wider pattern rather than a contained incident.
Outlook 7 Days: Next seven days: track security notices for Pakistan, repeat attacks, access restrictions, casualty updates and any confirmed effect on nearby transport or operating sites.

4 corroborating sources

Australia | Australia
17 Sep 2026
Australia migration policy tightening

Category: Regulatory
Current Severity: Moderate
Assessment: Australia tightened migration and visa settings, changing eligibility and documentation requirements for affected workers and visitors.
Polestar View: This is a transition risk: the business effect will be set by the implementation timetable and the practical interpretation of new eligibility rules.
Outlook 7 Days: Next seven days: watch official implementation guidance, employer-facing instructions and any change to the effective timetable.

13 corroborating sources

Thailand | Narathiwat
18 Sep 2026
Bomb, shooting attack on defence volunteer truck in Narathiwat

Category: Armed Conflict
Current Severity: High
Assessment: Attackers detonated a bomb and opened fire on a vehicle carrying territorial defence volunteers in Narathiwat on 18 September.
Polestar View: The event is most consequential if follow-on security measures restrict access around Narathiwat, disrupt nearby operations or indicate a wider pattern rather than a contained incident.
Outlook 7 Days: Next seven days: track security notices for Narathiwat, repeat attacks, access restrictions, casualty updates and any confirmed effect on nearby transport or operating sites.

BUSINESS IMPLICATIONS

The combined evidence calls for targeted changes, not a region-wide escalation. For people and travel, the immediate exposure is in Pakistan and Thailand. Journey approval, local movement and site-security decisions should reflect the named attack or military areas; the current evidence does not support treating every airport, border or city in those markets as disrupted. No selected development establishes a new logistics, utility, weather or cyber constraint. For regulatory and market-access decisions, the changes in Australia should be applied only to the affected visa, nationality, worker or compliance groups. HR and mobility teams need the effective date, treatment of existing permissions and employer documentation requirements before remobilising staff or changing hiring assumptions. Business-continuity planning should connect these exposures rather than count them. The practical stress point is where a local security event removes a route while staffing or regulatory constraints reduce the ability to recover. Current reporting does not establish that compound failure, but it identifies the locations and cohorts where it could emerge. Decision-makers should therefore assign owners to verify each operating fact, maintain alternatives for time-critical movements and escalate only when a verified closure, repeated attack or binding rule broadens the consequence.

7 DAY WATCH

2026-09-27 | Islamabad, Pakistan | Supporters of Imran Khan's party to march toward Islamabad on September 27: Khyber Pakhtunkhwa

Movement and access in Islamabad, Pakistan may be affected by the scheduled activity. Current severity: Moderate. Track route and venue advisories, transport changes and police restrictions.

POLESTAR OUTLOOK

The next-week judgement is not that APAC faces uniform deterioration. The question is whether the current events remain bounded to their reported locations or begin to affect the systems businesses depend on. In Pakistan and Thailand, repeat attacks, new checkpoints, displacement or official access restrictions would be the first evidence of escalation beyond the incidents already recorded. No selected transport, energy, weather or cyber event currently creates a regional continuity constraint. In Australia, the important signal is implementation: affected eligibility classes, effective dates and employer obligations matter more than further political commentary. The specific indicators are track security notices for Pakistan, repeat attacks, access restrictions, casualty updates and any confirmed effect on nearby transport or operating sites; official implementation guidance, employer-facing instructions and any change to the effective timetable; and track security notices for Narathiwat, repeat attacks, access restrictions, casualty updates and any confirmed effect on nearby transport or operating sites. Stabilisation would be indicated by restored operations, no repeat attack, and narrowly scoped implementation guidance. Deterioration would require the opposite: repeated violence near operating nodes, a disruption extending into a major route, or a policy measure broadening to additional workforce or market-access groups. Until one of those thresholds is crossed, controls should remain tied to the exposed location, route or cohort rather than applied across the region.

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